

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	SFT514
Subject Title	Craftsmanship and Culture
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	This subject aims to: 1. Provide an overview of the history of crafts and how they are contextualized and used in fashion. 2. Equip students to interrogate and explore crafts independently. 3. Develop a granular understanding of specific artisan techniques and their contemporary relevance and discourse. 4. Enhance a student's understanding of the relationship between luxury goods and the crafts sector.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students understand the history of specific artisan skills and develop the ability to articulate their creative concepts in relation to wider intellectual ideas: a) Have the ability to identify and name various craft techniques and their historical significance. b) Identify tools and equipment used. c) Know how to 'read' a completed fashion collection and recognise the craftsmanship. d) Recognise the time and training required to master a skill. e) Speak confidently about an array of artisan crafts, and their cultural origins. f) Identify opportunities in their own practice for the inclusion of new artisan work.

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus (Note 2)	This compulsory course establishes a firm understanding of artisan craftsmanship being actively employed in the fashion industry today. The course provides students with historical and cultural context for each technique studied and a practical understanding around the contemporary application and practical durability. Topics covered in lectures could include: 1. A survey of fashion-related artisan crafts including embroidery techniques, passementerie, weaving, lacemaking, dyeing etc. Then a more comprehensive look at specific crafts: 2. Goldwork: From Europe's Middle Ages to Indonesia and the modern runway. 3. Not just women's work: Tambor beading as a historical leisure pursuit and contemporary practice of haute couture. 4. Lacemaking and the introduction of automation. 5. The oldest craft: Weaving and its vast legacy. 6. Machines of craft: From hand-held tools to electric-powered machinery. Exercises: ○ Students will complete written analysis and explorations of techniques that interest them. ○ They should also be able to present a visual analysis of a collection identifying the techniques and explaining the themes. ○ A multiweek exercise will see the students develop and essay question to be approved by the tutor and complete in-depth research resulting in the submission of a paper.
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	This online course combines presented lecturers, discussion, independent research and directed readings. Students will be encouraged to develop their own specific interests as the course develops. Recorded lectures are designed to introduce topics that can be explored in greater depth through independent research and provided articles. Video lectures can pose questions and offer prompts for further independent research.

	<u>Presentations 20%</u> The presentation will allow the students to share their findings and to field questions and feedback in order to strengthen their research and presentation skills. It will also give the student a chance to practice their verbal and visual presentation skills. The materials submitted for this assessment must be the student's own work. The submitted work may not be accepted for the purpose of assessment if its authenticity is questionable. Submitting GenAI-generated materials as students' own work or part of their work is an act of academic dishonesty. Students who are found committing academic dishonesty will face disciplinary actions. <u>Term Research Project 50%</u> Students will synthesize the research, analytical, and presentation skills learned in this course to develop a term project on a relevant topic of their interest that is related to their capstone project. The materials submitted for this assessment must be the student's own work. The submitted work may not be accepted for the purpose of assessment if its authenticity is questionable. Submitting GenAI-generated materials as students' own work or part of their work is an act of academic dishonesty. Students who are found committing academic dishonesty will face disciplinary actions.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures and presentations	26 Hrs.
	▪ Discussions, critiques, shared discoveries etc.	13 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Exercises	19.5 Hrs.
	▪ Self-study and completing assignments	46.5 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	105 Hrs.
Reading List and References	The Invention of Craft, Glenn Adamson Craft, (Documents of Contemporary Art), Tanya Harrod The Golden Thread, Kassia St Clair The Subversive Stitch, Rozsika Parker Embellishment/Smuk: A New Light on Decorative Techniques, Karolien De Clippel	

Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

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